

❖ [Nelson Mandela – Long Walk to Freedom] ❖



📖 Summary

This chapter is an extract from Mandela's autobiography. It is about his inauguration as the first Black President of South Africa on 10 May 1994. Mandela talks about apartheid – a cruel system where Black people were discriminated against by White people. He spent 30 years in prison for fighting against it. On inauguration day, he saw freedom finally coming. He says

courage is not absence of fear but victory over it.
He believes love comes naturally, hate is taught.
A man has twin duties – to his family and to his
country. He says the oppressor and the
oppressed both are prisoners of hatred.

সাৰাংশ

এই অধ্যায়টো মেণ্ডেলাৰ আত্মজীৱনীৰ উদ্ধৃতি। ১৯৯৪ চনৰ ১০
মে'ত দক্ষিণ আফ্ৰিকাৰ প্ৰথম কৃষ্ণাংগ ৰাষ্ট্ৰপতি হিচাপে তেওঁৰ
কাৰ্যভাৰ গ্ৰহণৰ বিষয়ে। মেণ্ডেলাই বৰ্ণবৈষম্যৰ কথা কয় - যিটো
নিষ্ঠুৰ ব্যৱস্থা য'ত কৃষ্ণাংগ লোকসকলৰ বিৰুদ্ধে বগা লোকে
বৈষম্য কৰিছিল। ইয়াৰ বিৰুদ্ধে যুঁজ দিয়াৰ বাবে তেওঁ ৩০ বছৰ
কাৰাগাৰত কটাবলগীয়া হয়। উদ্বোধনী দিনটোত অৱশেষত
স্বাধীনতা আহি থকা দেখিলে। তেওঁ কয় যে সাহস হৈছে ভয়ৰ
অনুপস্থিতি নহয় বৰঞ্চ তাৰ ওপৰত জয়। তেওঁৰ বিশ্বাস প্ৰেম
স্বাভাৱিকতে আছে, ঘৃণা শিকোৱা হয়। এজন পুৰুষৰ যমজ
কৰ্তব্য থাকে - নিজৰ পৰিয়ালৰ প্ৰতি আৰু নিজৰ দেশৰ প্ৰতি।
তেওঁ কয় যে অত্যাচাৰী আৰু নিপীড়িত দুয়োজনেই ঘৃণাৰ বন্দী।

6 Important Q&A for Exam

1. When did Mandela become President and what was special about it?

Ans: On 10 May 1994 Mandela became the first Black President of South Africa after first democratic elections.

2. What is apartheid?

Ans: Apartheid is a system of racial discrimination where Black people were separated from White people and denied basic rights.

3. What did Mandela think about courage?

Ans: He thought courage is not absence of fear, but triumph over it. A brave man is one who conquers fear.

4. What are twin obligations of a man?

Ans: Every man has obligations to his family and to his people and country. In apartheid South Africa, Black people could not fulfill both.

5. Why did Mandela say oppressor and oppressed both are prisoners?

Ans: The oppressor is a prisoner of hatred and prejudice. The oppressed is a prisoner of suffering. Both need freedom from it.

6. What is the message of this chapter?

Ans: Freedom, equality, and love are important. We must fight for justice and not hate others. True freedom is for all.

◆◆◆◆Thinking about the Text◆◆◆◆

1. Why did such a large number of international leaders attend the inauguration? What did it signify the triumph of?

Ans: A large number of international leaders attended the inauguration because it was the first democratic, non-racial government in South Africa.

It was a historic moment. South Africa had just become free from apartheid after many years of struggle. Their presence signified the triumph of justice over injustice, good over evil, and the victory of a tolerant society. It showed that the world supported the new idea of freedom and equality for all.

2. What does Mandela mean when he says he is "simply the sum of all those African patriots" who had gone before him?

Ans: Mandela means that his freedom and success are not his alone. They are the result of

the sacrifices of many African patriots before him.

Many brave leaders fought and died for freedom. Their struggle and courage made his victory possible. He is grateful to them and considers himself as a part of their long struggle. He is continuing their work.

3. Would you agree that the "depths of oppression" create "heights of character"? How does Mandela illustrate this? Can you add your own examples to this argument?

Ans: Yes, depths of oppression create heights of character. When people suffer too much, they become stronger and braver.

Mandela illustrates this by giving examples of many great African patriots. He talks about Oliver

Tambo, Walter Sisulu, Chief Luthuli and others. They suffered a lot under apartheid but did not give up. Their suffering made them brave, patient and strong leaders.

My own example: Mahatma Gandhi suffered in South Africa and in India but his suffering made him a great leader. Similarly, Bhagat Singh faced oppression but his character became an inspiration for youth.

4. How did Mandela's understanding of freedom change with age and experience?

Ans: As a boy, he thought freedom meant to run in fields and do what he wanted. As a student, he thought freedom meant to stay out at night and read what he liked. As a young man, he wanted freedom to earn, marry and live with dignity. Later he saw his people were not free, so his own

freedom had no meaning. Then he wanted freedom for all South Africans. His idea changed from personal freedom to freedom for all.

5. How did Mandela's 'hunger for freedom' change his life?

Ans: At first Mandela had hunger for personal freedom. Later his hunger became for freedom of his people. This changed his life from a law-abiding citizen to a criminal. He left his family and became bold. He joined African National Congress and fought against apartheid. He sacrificed his personal life for his country and spent 30 years in jail for this struggle.

◆◆◆Thinking about Language◆◆◆

1. Make a list of such pairs of nouns and verbs in the text.

Noun - Verb

rebellion – rebel

constitution – constitute

inauguration – inaugurate

formation – form

government – govern

obligation – oblige

discrimination – discriminate

oppression – oppress

deprivation – deprive

transformation – transform

imagination – imagine

2. Read the paragraph below. Fill in the blanks with the noun forms of the verbs in brackets.

Martin Luther King's **contribution** (contribute) to our history as an outstanding leader began when he came to the **assistance** (assist) of Rosa

Parks, a seamstress who refused to give up her seat on a bus to a white passenger. In those days American Blacks were confined to positions of second class citizenship by restrictive laws and customs. To break these laws would mean **subjugation** (subjugate) and **humiliation** (humiliate) by the police and the legal system. Beatings, **imprisonment** (imprison) and sometimes death awaited those who defied the System. Martin Luther King's tactics of protest involved non-violent **resistance** (resist) to racial injustice.
